Lumen Robotics Employee Handbook

This handbook describes how people work together at Lumen Robotics, the company that designs and operates warehouse robots from its headquarters in Rotterdam. It applies to every full time and part time employee. Contractors should read the sections on conduct and security, and their agreement covers the rest. The handbook is maintained by the People Operations team, and questions can be sent to people@lumenrobotics.example. Where this handbook and an individual employment contract disagree, the contract wins.

We keep the rules short on purpose. Most of what follows exists so that nobody has to guess, and so that managers can say yes quickly.

Working hours and attendance

The standard working week at Lumen Robotics is 38 hours, spread over five days. Most teams work Monday to Friday, but the operations and field service teams run rotating shifts that are agreed with their managers at the start of each quarter. Part time employees keep the same rules with their hours scaled in proportion.

Core hours are 10:00 to 15:00 Central European Time. During core hours you are expected to be reachable for meetings and quick questions. Outside core hours you decide when to start and stop, as long as you complete your contracted hours across the week. Please do not schedule recurring meetings outside core hours without the agreement of everyone invited.

Time is recorded in the HR portal on a weekly basis. You do not need to clock in and out, but you do need to confirm your week by Monday noon of the following week. Managers review unconfirmed weeks every Tuesday.

Overtime is not paid out as money. If a manager asks you to work beyond your contracted hours for an incident or a customer deadline, the extra hours are banked as time off in lieu and should be taken within three months. On call duty is separate from overtime and is described in the engineering runbook rather than here.

The office in Rotterdam is open from 07:30 to 19:00. Visitors must be registered at reception, and they wear a visitor badge at all times. Badges for employees are issued on the first day and replaced free of charge once; a second replacement costs EUR 15.

Vacation

Full time employees receive 27 working days of paid vacation per calendar year. The entitlement accrues at 2.25 days per month, so an employee who joins in the middle of the year receives a proportional share. Public holidays in the Netherlands are not counted against vacation days.

Requests are made in the HR portal. A request for three days or fewer needs only your manager's approval and should be answered within two working days. A request for 10 working days or more in a row must be submitted at least four weeks in advance, so that teams can plan coverage. Managers cannot refuse a request without suggesting an alternative period.

You may carry over up to 5 unused vacation days into the next year. Carried over days expire on 31 March, and the portal sends a reminder in February. Days above the carry over limit are lost, except where an absence made it impossible to take them, in which case People Operations will extend the deadline.

Employees who leave the company are paid for unused vacation days in their final salary payment. If an employee has taken more days than they accrued, the difference is deducted from the same payment.

Between Christmas Day and New Year's Day the office is closed for a company wide shutdown. The shutdown days are granted in addition to the vacation entitlement, so nobody has to spend their own days on it. Operations and field service teams keep a skeleton rota during the shutdown and receive extra time off in return.

Sick leave and other absences

If you are unwell, tell your manager before the start of your working day, using chat or a phone call. You do not need to explain the illness. For the first 3 days of an illness no doctor's note is required. From the fourth day of absence, a note from a doctor or from the occupational health service is required, and People Operations will contact you about support for returning to work.

Sick leave is paid in full for the first 45 calendar days of each absence period. After that, pay continues according to the national sickness benefit scheme, and People Operations will explain the details individually. Sick days never reduce the vacation entitlement.

Bereavement leave is 5 working days when a partner, child, parent or sibling dies, and 2 working days for grandparents and parents in law. If you need more time, speak to your manager; additional days can be taken as vacation or unpaid leave.

Medical appointments should be scheduled outside core hours where possible. When that is not possible, there is no need to book time off for appointments shorter than two hours.

Employees who volunteer for a recognised charity can take up to 2 paid volunteering days per year, to be agreed with the manager in advance.

Remote work

Lumen Robotics is an office first company with generous remote options. Employees whose role allows it may work from home up to 3 days per week. The days are agreed at team level, and teams are asked to keep at least one common office day each week so that planning and workshops can happen in person. Roles that touch physical robots, such as the test hall and field service, are on site by default.

To set up a home workspace, the company pays a one off home office stipend of EUR 450. It can be spent on a desk, a chair, a monitor or lighting, and receipts must be submitted through the expense system. On top of that, the company pays EUR 40 per month towards your internet connection while you work remotely at least one day per week.

Working from another country is possible for up to 20 days per calendar year, with approval from People Operations before you travel. Tax and social security rules differ between countries, and we must check them for each case. Approval is not granted for countries where the company has no legal basis to employ people, and it is never granted for roles that require access to export controlled robot firmware.

When working remotely, you must connect through the company VPN before opening any internal system. Public Wi-Fi may only be used together with the VPN. Please also lock your screen whenever you leave your device, even at home, and do not let family members use your work laptop. The details of the VPN setup are in the security policy.

Remote workers are asked to be visible in the team calendar, to update their status in chat when they step away for longer than an hour, and to turn on their camera in meetings with external guests.

Equipment and devices

Every employee receives a company laptop on the first day. Standard laptops are refreshed every 36 months. Engineers who need more computing power for simulation can request a workstation class machine from their director. Phones are not issued by default; employees who are on call receive a company phone for the duration of their rota.

Company devices remain the property of Lumen Robotics. They may be used for light private browsing, but not for storing private photos, tax documents or any software that is not approved by IT. Do not install tools that bypass security controls, even if they seem harmless.

If a device is lost or stolen, follow the procedure in the security policy and also inform your manager. A replacement for a stolen laptop needs the approval of your director, who will usually ask for the police report number before ordering. Devices that are damaged through carelessness more than once may be replaced at the employee's own cost, decided case by case.

Peripherals such as keyboards, mice and headsets can be ordered through the IT portal up to a value of EUR 120 per year without further approval. Larger items follow the normal expense process.

When you leave the company, return all devices within 5 working days of your last day. IT will wipe them after the return is registered.

Business travel

Travel is booked through the company travel desk, except for train journeys within the Netherlands, which can be bought directly. Economy class is used for all flights shorter than 6 hours. For longer flights, premium economy is allowed, and business class requires approval from a vice president.

Hotels should be booked at the corporate rate where one exists. If there is no corporate rate, the nightly limit is EUR 160 including breakfast and taxes. Exceptions during major trade fairs, when prices rise sharply, must be approved by the manager before booking.

When you travel by private car for work, the mileage allowance is EUR 0.31 per kilometre. Please log the start and end address of each trip in the expense system. Parking and tolls are reimbursed at cost when a receipt is attached.

Travel insurance is arranged by the company for all business trips and covers medical costs, cancellation and baggage. Keep the policy number from the travel confirmation with you. In an emergency abroad, call the assistance number printed on the travel confirmation first, and then your manager.

Time spent travelling during working hours counts as working time. Travel outside working hours is compensated as time off in lieu at half the travel time, up to a maximum of one day per trip.

Expenses

You may spend company money when it is necessary for your work, but you must be able to show what it was spent on. Submit claims in the expense system within 30 days of the purchase. Claims older than 30 days are only paid with the approval of the finance director.

A receipt is required for every expense above EUR 25. Below that amount, a short description is enough. Receipts can be photographed and uploaded, and the original does not need to be kept after the claim is paid.

While travelling, meals are reimbursed up to EUR 55 per day in total. Alcohol is not reimbursed, except for a moderate amount at a client dinner that has been announced to the manager beforehand. Team meals during a project workshop are reimbursed up to EUR 30 per person.

Approvals follow the size of the claim. Your manager approves claims up to EUR 500. Claims above EUR 500 also need the approval of a director. Approved claims are paid in the next payroll cycle, which runs on the 25th of each month. Claims approved after the 18th of the month are normally paid in the following cycle.

Corporate cards are available to employees who travel regularly. A card statement must be reconciled in the expense system by the 5th of the following month. Cash advances are not offered.

Memberships, subscriptions and software are not expenses. Please request them through the IT portal so that licences can be tracked, and so that security can review the supplier.

Learning and development

Every employee has a personal learning budget of EUR 1,200 per year. It can be used for courses, books, conferences and certifications related to your role or your career plans. Conference tickets are paid from the budget, while the travel is paid by the team. Unused budget does not carry over to the next year.

Employees are also entitled to 3 days of paid study leave per year for courses or exams. New starters get a mentor from another team for their first six months, and the company runs a quarterly internal talk series where anyone can present a project.

Performance conversations take place twice a year, in April and in October. They are about growth and feedback, not about pay: salary reviews are handled separately in January.

Conduct and speaking up

We expect colleagues to treat each other with respect, to be honest about mistakes and to protect customer and company information. Harassment, discrimination and retaliation are not tolerated, whether in the office, at events or online.

If you see something that concerns you, you can talk to your manager, to People Operations or to the confidential contact person, whose details are on the intranet. Reports can also be submitted anonymously through the ethics line. Nobody who reports a concern in good faith will be disadvantaged.

Gifts from suppliers or customers may be accepted only if they are modest and given openly. Report any gift with a value above EUR 50 to your manager so that it can be logged. Never accept money, vouchers or invitations that could influence a decision.

Leaving the company

The probation period for new employees is 6 months. During probation either side may end the employment with one month of notice. After probation, the notice period set in your contract applies. Most contracts use two months.

Before the last day, your manager will agree a handover plan with you, and People Operations will arrange an exit conversation. Access to systems is removed at the end of your last working day. Employees who leave in good standing are welcome to stay in touch through the alumni channel, and many former colleagues have returned to Lumen Robotics later in their careers.